

THE CHOICES WEEKEND

Instructor's Manual

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01/09/92

GENERAL RESPONSIBILITIES

ONE WEEK BEFORE

Talk to Team Leader and Rep. Find out how things are going. Get connected.

THURSDAY EVENING

Meet with logistics team during the room set-up if this is either the first or second Weekend in an area. After that, it is the instructor-trainee/rep's responsibility to meet with the team to set the context of the seminar.

Make sure that the staff understands the **context** we want to hold for the seminar—**personal responsibility**. Ask them to agree to confidentiality about the participants' work.

During set-up (or early next morning), prepare the posters for the first day. Do the drawings and some of the words—leaving out the key words. You will fill these in when you teach the information.

(Supervise the room set-up if this is the first seminar in that area and QED has not sent a Team Leader. Use the room set-up guidelines in the Weekend Production Manual. The Rep or someone from his office should do the registration the next morning.)

QED is now sending an Instructor Manual for the Team Leader to follow.

DURING THE WORKSHOP

Meet with the staff at lunch each day for clearing, sharing feelings, and supporting the logistics team. This is very important for bonding the graduate staff into a strong network.

If you are training a new instructor, meet before the seminar, on breaks and during dinner to support them in the area they need work: (presentation of info, connecting with participants, control, giving space, holding the largest context, going deep, speaking only from heart, etc.)

TIMES: Instructor

7:00 - 9:30 Thursday eve
8:30 - 6:00 Friday
9:00 - 6:00 Saturday
9:00 - 6:00 Sunday

Participants

10:00 - 9:00 Friday
9:00 - 9:00 Saturday
9:00 - 6:00 Sunday

AT THE END OF THE WORKSHOP:

It is your responsibility after the program to submit to QED:

1. The check from the Rep for QED
2. Logistics feedback forms
3. Participant feedback forms
4. Instructor feedback form
5. Instructor pay/expense form
6. Roster
7. Participant Agreement Forms (QED copy)
8. Logistics Box (if sent by QED)

General Guidelines

- Alternate between teaching and sharing.
- Use each issue that comes up as an opportunity to teach.
- Refer to and teach from posters at every opportunity.
- When sharing is done at each instance teach the next piece of information that flows from what is going on.
- Don't spend too much time focusing on one person because the space will go dead.
- Don't take reactions seriously. If someone is in reaction, open the space by teaching the entire room.
- **Always go to the biggest picture.**
- Use the songs to evoke a common experience AFTER a piece of work has been done.
- (Have a list of the songs available to you and to the music person. See the description in the back of the manual for what each song evokes. Make sure you are familiar with the songs.)
- Don't let anything go by that will facilitate the learning.
- Sometimes it is important not to say anything if you feel dangerous.
- If the room is thick, talk about it.
- Let the work go deep, but don't get caught in the content of people's issues.
- Use Louise Hay book to talk about disease when it comes up.
- Have the video person film all the posters on each person's video at the end of the last day.
- Remember you are not there to heal people - only to provide them with a focal point for change.
- After you do a piece of work, make space for people to share. Remember that people can only hold one piece of teaching every ten minutes and one pattern per hour.
- Make sure you create space for participants to learn by keeping the space inside of you open.

PROGRAM OUTLINE

FIRST DAY:

Meet with logistics staff at 8:30 a.m. Registration is at 9:30.
Begin seminar on time - 10:00 a.m.

Play: "Imagine" and "The Rose" (Hand out words)

(Music: play instrumental music softly in background throughout seminar)

(Take breaks approximately every 1 1/2 hours)

(Note: the text in italics is suggested dialogue)

Open the Space

Introduce yourself; be intimate. Include what fits in the moment. Start modeling connection, intimacy and responsibility.

Core of Weekend:

Ask: *"If you found out today that you had one year left to live, what would you want to do? (Let them answer after each question.) What would you do if you found out you had only one month? One week? What would you be doing that you aren't doing now? Why not now? This weekend is about why you haven't done those things."*

Share more about what the Weekend is really about: *Having a happy life. You do this by rediscovering and clarifying your purpose and making sure that you have a very clear vision of where you are going in your life and some action steps to help you on your way; being able to deeply connect with what you truly desire in your life and to discover what has kept you from having it. It's also about learning how to re-pattern whatever thoughts or beliefs that are limiting you, and gives you a model for how to change anything you want to change about yourself.*

☞ Ask if there are any questions.

☞ *Today's focus will be on what got you where you are now. Tomorrow's focus will be on how to change it and the last day we are going to create our future.*

☞ Exercise: 7-11 Game

To cue up game, ask: *How many people never judge anyone? We have a game to help you remember.* Hand out roles. Give the groups 15 minutes to discuss the scenario.....Debrief.

☞ **Explain: (keep it light and short)**

- Breaks are about every 1 1/2 hours. Tell them where the break food will be.
- Videotapes—if using—are for them to have a record of their personal work. Ask if anyone doesn't want to be videotaped.
- Music will be played softly throughout and sometimes we will play songs to support a piece of work someone is doing.
- Meals: let them know if lunch is being provided or if they are on their own for lunch. They will go out with their groups for dinner.
- Groups: To support them in integrating the material, they will be choosing groups to meet with during and after dinner and at breakfast for the rest of the seminar. Have them look around and check each other out to see who they want in their group.
- The instruction ends at dinner each day. The seminar ends on Sunday at about 5:00.
- Availability of speaker phone for people who wish to handle something by phone with the support of the group.
- Confidentiality (Remind them that this was on their participation agreements.) Go over the essence of confidentiality—that we want to create a space where it is safe to say anything.

- **Hand out workbooks.**
- Introduce the logistics team: *The logistics staff have done the Weekend and they are here to review this information and to support you in this seminar.*

BREAK (PLAY INSTRUMENTAL MUSIC.)

 Let them know that the piece of information you are about to teach is a **key to getting everything they want** out of the seminar and life in general.

HEAD VS. HEART



Your mind is a catalogue of your past experiences. It provides valuable reference points. Its purpose is to accumulate information and process that information according to what you have already learned. Your heart is what's happening now. It has no principles. It tells you what is true about the present moment. Your heart responds from the purpose you are committed to at the moment. All of us are living according to some purpose, mostly unconsciously and from our history. If your purpose changes, so will the answer from your heart. We need a marriage of our hearts and minds to be complete. Both are valuable.

Check it out!

Have them look up into their head and ask why they came this weekend. Then, have them look down into their heart and ask their heart why they came here this weekend. (*Refer them to workbook: page 2*)

 **Participants Share** (RECORD ON EACH PERSON'S TAPE) Have participants share what they want from the Weekend and how committed they are to doing what they need to do to get it. Let them define commitment. (DON'T LET THIS TAKE TOO MUCH TIME.)

Guided Meditation (MUSIC: "KITARO KI")

Instructions: Do not read this word for word. Make it live.
Leave enough space after each statement for people to visualize.

We would like you to consider the scenario in this meditation as a possibility:

Close your eyes and get comfortable... Float backwards in time... Feel yourself drift backwards to your past...

You may feel like you are spinning...

Go way, way back... back before you had a body... before conception... back to when you were just a spirit.

From that space of being a spirit, create a triangle, a pyramid with a floor, made of white light—of unconditional love... Walk into your pyramid....

Call in the spirits of your mother and father....

Ask your parents why they want you.... Why did they choose you?

Ask your spirit why you chose them as parents and trust the answer you get... What is the lesson that you can learn from them?

*Now ask your spirit what **your purpose** is for being here...for this life.*

*Then let your parents go. Let the white light and the pyramid disappear... Stay with your awareness of your purpose! Let yourself know what it was like when you were conceived...What your parents were feeling and thinking. Allow yourself to go into the womb... remember what it **felt like** to be in there... You are more than just a body... you are also a spirit: watching... feeling... seeing. Let yourself feel how it is to grow inside your mother's womb... Experience whatever is going on.*

It is time to be born. You are being born to accomplish a purpose... Know that you chose to be born... Let your senses experience your birth—the first step in accomplishing your purpose. Let yourself feel what it is like to be born... Is there anesthesia?... Or is your birth natural?... Are forceps used?... Is it a Caesarian?... Are you breech?... Premature? Let yourself remember and experience being born... Is it easy?... Is it hard?... Does it feel good... Or not?

What do you see first when you are born? ...What do you taste?... hear?... feel?... smell? Let yourself know if you made any decisions about you or about life when you were born...

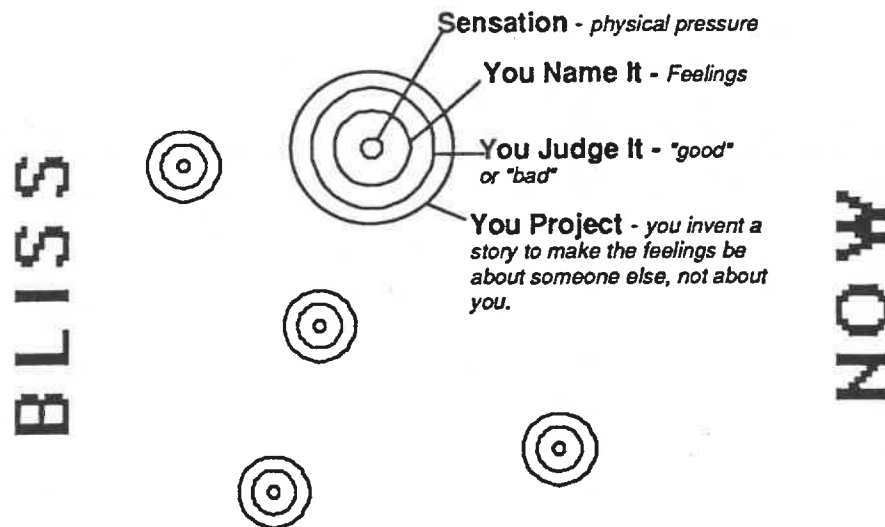
*Now come back to the present time... very slowly. **Remember your purpose!** Keep your eyes closed... Feel the floor here... Move your arms, legs, feet. Open your eyes. Look around. How do people look to you right now?*

BREAK (15 min.) During the break, have them share with someone what the meditation was like and complete page 4 in their workbooks. (PLAY INSTRUMENTAL MUSIC)

Sharing

BLISS/NOW Poster: (Refer to workbook pg. 5)

We want to talk now about what happens from the time we are conceived to how our belief systems are formed—why we think the way we do.



Talk about what it was like for most people in the womb—Bliss, safety, peace.

Then ask: *whose mother smoked?*

*It created a **physical sensation** for the fetus.* (Put a dot in the space between bliss and now.)

So did drinking, anxiety, stress, adrenaline. (Put a few more dots in the space between bliss and now.)

*The sensations were just sensations at first. When our mother or father were having physical sensations, **they called them a feeling.** Then they put a value on that feeling (good or bad). And*

then they covered all that with a story about why that feeling was about someone else or because of someone else.

In the womb all we felt were sensations. We also absorbed the thoughts and value judgements that our mother had about those sensations. They didn't mean anything to us, but they were the seeds of how we would think later. (We go into this part more deeply in the ETP, which is an extended program that graduates of the Weekend can go on to do.)

As very young babies we still had mostly sensations. Later as we grew up we learned to call those sensations feelings, just like our parents did.

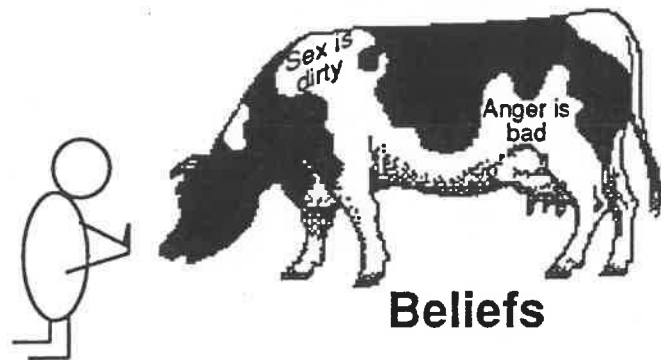
Our parents did what they did because that's what they chose to do with their lives. It had nothing to do with us, good or bad.

*However, we learned to do the same thing they did. And we still do: First there is a **sensation**, (point out another dot) then we give it a **name**, (put a circle around the dot) then we **judge** that feeling when we put a **value** on it (put a larger circle around the first circle), and then we create a story or reason for how the feeling is because of or about someone else.*

We all learned to do that with our sensations. It's rare for anyone to just experience their sensations without labeling them. It's the story that's the problem. Because when we cover up our sensations and feelings, we are removed from ourselves—from what is really going on in us.

If the cover-ups got reinforced and repeated with consistency, they became a pattern that we don't even notice anymore.

BELIEFS: *In time these patterns became beliefs, things that we thought were true about life or about ourselves without questioning them. They became like a sacred cow. (Refer them to workbook pg. 6)*



Have participants do a few of their own examples of sensations, feelings, and value judgements. Put on flip chart.

FEELINGS:

Teach about what feelings are: *What we call feelings are the names we give sensations. From now on what we are going to call feelings is what babies experience as sensations. (Make sure this is clear.)*

Teach that the feelings we had as children and their value judgements are still there. Some people refer to this energy as “the Inner Child.” **That energy is what we are working with in this seminar. We can repattern ourselves so that we will be more in touch with the truth of our experience.**

We learned to interpret our sensations the same way our families did. If our family called a sensation of fluttering in our stomach “fear” then so did we. But if our family called that same fluttery sensation excitement, we did, too.

And then we learned from them which feelings were OK and which ones were not.

Group exercise: Choose groups of five. Share what feelings were OK in your family and which ones weren't—share what it was like in your family. (*Refer to workbook pg. 5*) (10-15 mins.)

Put their examples on a flip chart with one side for OK and one side for Not OK. Make sure that they notice that most feelings are on both sides, depending on what family they grew up in. The value is arbitrary and cultural.

Why do you think our families taught us that some feelings were good and some were bad?..... Let them tell you what they think.

Then when someone gives you an opening:

That's right. Because they wanted us to be safe. Value judgments were just our parents' way of protecting us. They were just passing on to us what they learned from their parents.

Some of what they taught us works and some of it doesn't.

This weekend you will have an opportunity to choose new thoughts, new interpretations of your sensations. What you used to call fear you might change to excitement. They are pretty close in how they feel physically. You will also have a chance to choose whether to feel all your feelings or not.

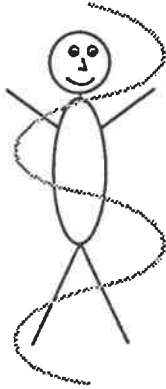
 *During lunch pick groups of 5 and share what it was like in your families.*

LUNCH BREAK (PLAY INSTRUMENTAL MUSIC)



FEELINGS ARE WAVES AND ARE ALL EQUAL

(Refer to workbook pg. 7)



*Feelings are just feelings. There **are** no “good” or “bad” ones. Who believes that? Interesting isn’t it? What was allowed in one family is different from what feelings were okay in another. Who’s to say what’s right or wrong about feelings?*

Think of what happens in a relationship when someone whose family thought fighting was fun marries someone whose family didn’t allow anger. Anybody ever have that in a relationship?

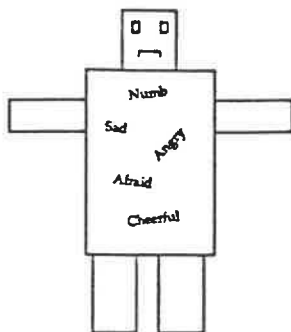
*Babies don’t judge their feelings/responses, so they go easily from anger to joy to sadness, etc. Ever spend any time with a baby? They can go from one to another in seconds. **Feelings are like waves. Let them flow through you.***

*When feelings aren’t obstructed, they pass through you and you have an **experience**. They are energy. When there is resistance to that experience, it gets stuck inside.*



FEELINGS NOT EXPERIENCED

PERSIST AND CONTROL YOU (Refer to workbook pg. 8)



Have the group say what feelings go in the drawing.

If a feeling doesn't go through you but gets stuck, it does something. It has a powerful effect. Who knows what stuck feelings create? Let them tell you. Include what they say in the teaching.

Stuck feelings stay inside you and color your experience of what you see without your conscious awareness that this is happening. For example, if a person is not able to feel afraid, they live in fear all the time and are not aware of it. But they may have five locks on their doors, keep their blinds drawn all the time, never go out and keep a gun in their glove compartment. They will think they are just being smart and never feel the fear. So what's the problem? Who wants to feel fear anyway? The problem is that if you don't feel it, you live in it, you become it. Your unexperienced fear filters everything. You will see dangers where there aren't any.

Living constantly in fear affects your health. Living constantly with any feeling stuck inside you affects your health. Refer to the Louise Hay book, "Heal Your Body."



Questions: (Make this really fun. Take your time.

Make a big deal over who wins for the most \$\$ stolen or the longest time in jail. Let people tell their stories about their answers.)

- Anybody *never lie?* (If yes, applaud them.)
- Anybody *never steal? How much? Over \$100?*
Over \$1000 On income taxes?
- Anybody *ever go bankrupt? Did you pay it back?*
- Has anybody *ever been in jail? How long and what for?*

- Anybody *ever kill anyone? In wartime? What happened?*
- Ever *hit a child or been hit as a child?*
- Ever *hit a mate? Been hit by a mate?*
- Anybody *ever give away a child? Been given away?*
- Have any children *with unknown whereabouts?*
- Anybody *adopted? Have adopted children?*
- Have someone *die when they were young? Who?*

- Any *suicides or attempts in family?*
- Anyone *ever attempt suicide?*
- Any family members *you haven't talked to for a long time? Who and how long? Why?*

- Any *eating disorders? What?*
- Any *addictions past or present? What? Still?*
- Any *other compulsive behaviors? What?*
- Any *terminal diseases? (refer to "Heal Your Body")*
- Any *chronic diseases? (refer to "Heal Your Body")*
- Any *heavy accidents?*

- Who is *single? Interested in anyone here?*
- Married? *More than once? How many times?*
- Divorced? *How many times?*
- Widows or widowers? *How long? Still miss them?*
- Any *virgins?*
- How old were you *the first time you had sex? Under 10?*

11?...12?...13?...14?...15?...16?...17?...18?...19?...

20?...21?...22?...23?...Anyone left? How old?

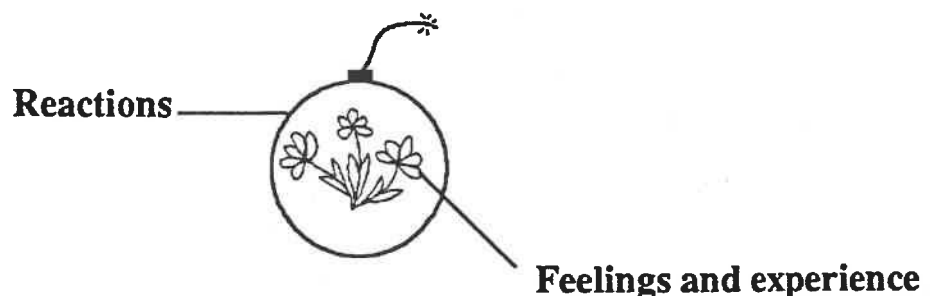
- How many people have you had sex with in your life?
- How many people ever saw their parents having sex?
- How many were sure their parents never had sex except to have children?

- Anybody ever have an affair? How many?
- Do all the people involved know about it?
- Sex with animals?
- Paid to have sex? Pay to have sex? How about for/with dinner or a washing machine?
- Anyone ever have sex with someone of the same sex?
- Anyone in a homosexual relationship now?
- Any incest experiences? With who? For how long?
- Anybody ever have an abortion? How many?
- Miscarriages? How many?
- Ever have a sexually transmitted disease? What?
- Ever been molested? Molested someone?
- Been raped? Rape someone?
- Ever have sex when you didn't want to? Why? Still?

 **BREAK** (PLAY "LET IT BE")

 **REACTIONS** (Refer to workbook pg. 9)

Reactions are a cover-up. They protect our true feelings and experience.



Reaction is the way we learned to survive in our family systems. It was the cover-up for the feelings that our families considered dangerous. Now when we feel threatened, we automatically use the same reactions. Even though the threat is about the past, not the present.

How do you know what is a reaction and what is a feeling? They can look alike.

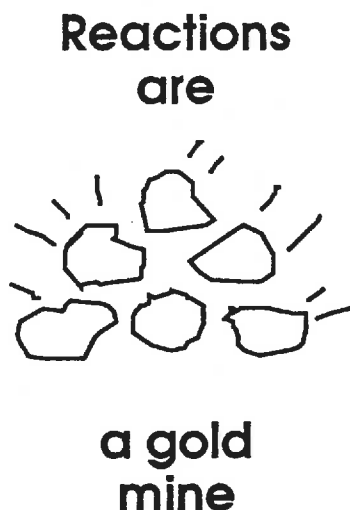
You know you are in reaction when there is a value judgement on what you are feeling.

A reaction is anything you do to cover your true experience.

Here are some Big Clues to know if you are in reaction:

- Your body always feels tight and anxious, not present.
- Events appear to be coming at you—you feel like a victim, a victimizer, and a judge all at the same time.
- You think that what you feel is because of someone else.
- Your mind won't shut up.
- You are judging yourself or someone else.
- You feel compelled to act or not to act.
- You think other people are doing something to you.
- Your thoughts relate to the past or the future, not the present.

Reactions are Gold Mines



*Taking
Care*

A reaction is a wonderful opportunity for freedom. It is a key to something you do that keeps you from being here in the present moment, so you can have what you want. If you stay open to learning while in reaction, you can choose a different behavior right in the middle of it. This changes the pattern.

You will probably be in reaction at some time during the seminar. We want to create the space for you to experience your reactions and see what the results are and then choose another pattern. Noticing our reactions and learning about ourselves from them is like alchemy. It is turning lead into gold.

Tomorrow you will learn the steps for how to get out of reaction.

 **Exercise:** Pick a partner. Share your favorite reaction with them. (*Refer to workbook pg. 10*)

Choose Groups

Have them split up into groups of 4-5. Let them know that they will be meeting in these groups all weekend. Have them notice what comes up when they are asked to pick groups. Ask them to eat together and to return to the seminar space and continue meeting after dinner until about 9:00. A staff member will be here.

Instruction for groups

*During dinner and then later please share secrets about you with your group. Tell them what effect each secret has had in your life. What would you have to do in order to have **one face**? As a group member, please support your team to say everything. Experience everything. Take nothing away from anyone.*

Ask them to take a walk or have breakfast in the morning with their group.

Class starts at 10:00 tomorrow.

☞ End with “Lean on Me” (hand out words)

DINNER

DAY TWO: (Logistics meeting about 9:00 a.m.)

Note: Important to focus on **intimacy and projection** —leave other material for when and if there is time. Instructor should have read all PDFs by the second day.

☞ Open with “The Rose” and/or “All This Joy.” (Hand out words.)

☞ Feeling Check

Teach about feeling check being about sensation - not content. Do feeling check in the room to demonstrate. Ask people to be brief. (Use feeling check occasionally during remainder of seminar to connect the group.) When we put it all together, we know what the room (all of us together) will experience.

☞ Sharing

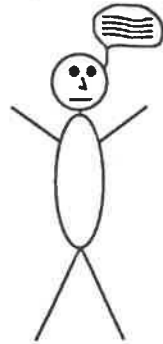
Any sharing about morning meeting with small group or about the day before.

☞ *Yesterday we talked about belief systems and how we got where we are today. Today we're going to learn how to take responsibility for how you create your experience and learn how it's not important what happened in our lives, but how we perceive what happened and how we take it out into the world.*

WISDOM (Refer to workbook pg. 11)



Wisdom is the
result of experience



Thoughts are the
result of
interpretations

As feelings are experienced and leave, wisdom and true learning occurs. We learn what is true about us and about the situation we are dealing with.

*When we attempt to interpret or figure out what we are feeling, without truthfully **experiencing** it in our body, we lose valuable information. We are handicapped without this information. We won't really know what is true about a situation. We will only know what we think about it and we will experience it from our thought, not from our true self.*

Physical experience makes true choice possible. Once we have experienced what we really feel we can make clear decisions about the situation. Experience creates a cellular shift.

Context

Context is one of the most important concepts we will be teaching this weekend. Context is what gives meaning to whatever happens or whatever you experience. It is the way you see

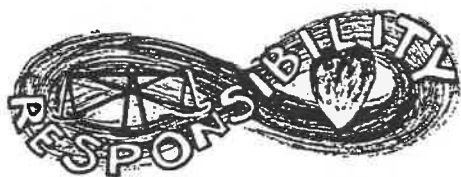
things. We all grew up having the context of our families. A family might have a context of Protestant, or Catholic, or Jewish, or black. It meant that those different families saw life a certain way and expected certain things to happen. Besides the cultural context there was also your family's historical context. For example, a family might have a context of "Our family is okay and everyone else is suspicious." Or the context of worry = loving, or the context of fighting = connection; or the context of everyone being separate. There are many, many contexts for how we see things.

The important thing is that your context determines how you see things and that determines your results. And the most important thing is that you can choose what context you want to live in. You do not have to keep the one you learned in your family.

We want to talk to you about a new context, which is what this weekend is really about.

Personal Responsibility (Refer to workbook pg. 12)

(The infinity symbol for this poster should be pre-drawn. Fill in the heart side as you teach the following:)



This is the context of personal responsibility, which is the context of Love. (As opposed to that of fear or pain.) It means that YOU are the source of your experience. You may think "How can that be so?! My father did this to me... My mother did that....."

To that child in you that stuff is true. "You are the source" does not mean that you chose to be beaten, or raped, or not be loved.

It means that you have the power to choose how you experience any of those things.

(USE A STORY COMPARABLE TO THE FOLLOWING, BUT USE ONE OF YOUR OWN, NOT THIS ONE.)

Example: a woman who was a member of one of our ETPs had a 9 year old daughter who became very ill with Chrones Disease. Her colon was so obstructed that her doctor had scheduled its removal in two days. The girl's mother asked the creators of this course, Judith Orloff-Falk and Peg Doubleday, to work with her daughter. They went to the hospital to see the little girl and saw that she was very well-behaved and quiet, even though she was very frightened. She was also extremely angry at her parents and the hospital staff but kept it bottled up. Lots of people do that. In her case the bottling up was physical as well as emotional. J&P told her she just might get better and be able to eat again (by this time she had been on intravenous medication for over a week), if she would get angry OUT LOUD at her mother and father and the nurses and doctors. Her parents told her they thought it was a good idea to do that. She decided she would get angry out loud at everybody in order to not have to have that operation and so that she could eat. And she did. She stopped being "good" and started telling everybody off. Her improvement was so rapid that within two days the removal of her colon was cancelled and she was allowed to eat. And within another week she went home from the hospital. Her illness has not recurred. She chose a different experience of what was going on.

*(Fill in the scale side of the infinity symbol as you teach the following:) The context of personal responsibility also means that you **do not judge** anything but you accept everything—all your choices, feelings, thoughts, even your judgements.*

(Refer to workbook pg. 12)

When you live from this context, there are some basic assumptions:

- 1) That your parents loved you unconditionally.*
- 2) That the world is neutral. 3) That people are just doing what they are doing, they are not right or wrong.*

 *Why don't people live this way? What stops us?
We are dedicated to our history, to our reactions.*

 *How you know if you are responsible: 1) There is no blame, 2) no justifying, 3) no hiding.*

 **The Seven Steps to Get Out of Reaction** *(Refer to wkbk. pg. 13)*

We guarantee that if you do all the steps you will be able to get out of reaction and be responsible.

1. Notice your thoughts and feelings. Are you blaming or justifying? If so, know you are in a reaction.

2. Experience your feelings truthfully. Look under your reaction to what you are experiencing and feeling.

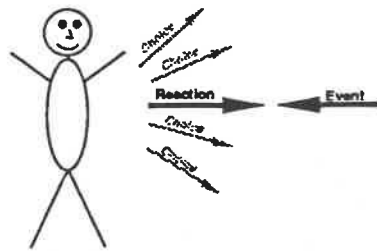
3. Be compassionate with yourself. Ask yourself how old your inner child is and what she or he is feeling. What are you doing now to continue those old feelings and thoughts?

4. Remind yourself that you are learning. This is very important—it makes the next step possible.

5. Risk choosing to be vulnerable. To be really vulnerable is the safest possible condition.

6. *Choose to be responsible for your interpretation of your experience. Remember that your interpretation is about you and your history.*
7. *Experience what is true in this situation, with these people, right now, without trying to change it. (no judgements). When you do this, you are re-patterning the beliefs that perpetuate this reaction.*

 Results of PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY (wkbk: pg. 14)



Response-ability:
the ability to respond
in the present
from unlimited options

The result of living from Personal Responsibility is that you create the response you choose from unlimited options. It is the foundation for freedom and personal power. It enables you to choose to live in the present, to realize that YOU make the choices and YOU create how your life has been and how it will be. You are free to create your life.

Give examples of reactions/patterned responses and making the shift to responsibility: *In a situation where you have always kept quiet because you are afraid of a fight, you would say what is true about you and risk someone being mad at you. Or in a situation where you blame someone for hurting you, you would find what thought or behavior of yours hurt you.*

Point it out all weekend when someone makes that shift to responsibility. Have them share or ask any questions they have.

UNCONDITIONAL LOVE (Refer to workbook pg. 15)



No exclusions

*Unconditional Love is a result of personal responsibility. It means that you **accept ALL** of you. All your feelings and thoughts, all of your body. It will end judgement and heal the shameful secrets you fearfully keep from the world. It brings clear integrated messages from your heart and mind.*

You don't need to say much about this. Just let the information sink in.

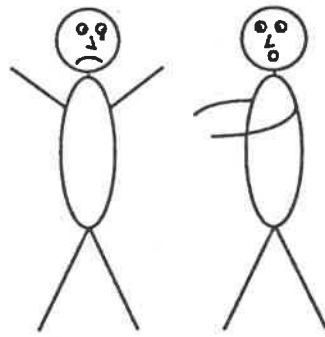
LUNCH BREAK (PLAY INSTRUMENTAL MUSIC)

CONTROL = FEAR OF LOSS (Refer to workbook pg. 16)



Ask them what they think control is and why people do it. *Control comes from fear of loss. When we control we try and get someone or ourselves to be different without being straight about it. Like trying to get someone to lose weight by putting a "Back Off Porky" sign on the refrigerator. It doesn't work anyway. It usually creates the result we are afraid of.*

👉 TAKING CARE OF = TAKING AWAY FROM
RESULTS IN LOSS OF POWER (Refer to workbook pg. 17)



*If you try to control someone else's feelings and experience so that YOU don't feel uncomfortable, you are **TAKING AWAY** wisdom from both of you. Whenever you do something for relief or to be comfortable, you give away your power.*

Sometimes the person you are focused on hasn't asked for anything and would rather just feel what they are feeling. When you do something to try and change what they are feeling, they have to stop everything so you will leave them alone.

For example, if you try and comfort someone when they are crying, they have to stop. And the compulsion to comfort them comes from your own discomfort with how you feel when they are crying.

Have you ever been crying and have someone try and hug you or give you tissues? How did it feel?

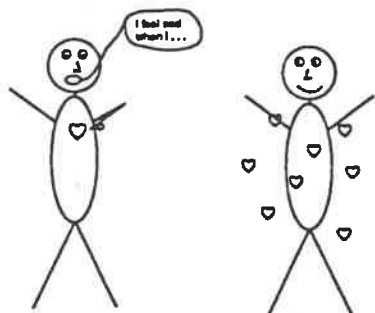
👉 Ask them to let each other have their feelings and to share their experience—this is what support is.

*For example, when someone is crying, support might be to say "I feel tender and connected to you when you cry. I had a hard time being with you before when you were trying not to cry."
Taking care of would be to hug the person and say, "There,*

there, everything will be alright.”

Talk about the difference in the INTENTION behind taking care of and support. *The intention behind support is connection and respect. The intention behind taking care of is to ease your own discomfort.*

INTIMACY - INTO ME SEE (Refer to workbook pg. 18)



Most people think intimacy is telling others their personal opinions and judgements. Or telling them something about them. This is into-you-see.

True intimacy is telling someone how you feel or how you think or what you experience without blaming the other person for it. Talking about you - your experience, your desires. To do that you have to let yourself know what those truths are.

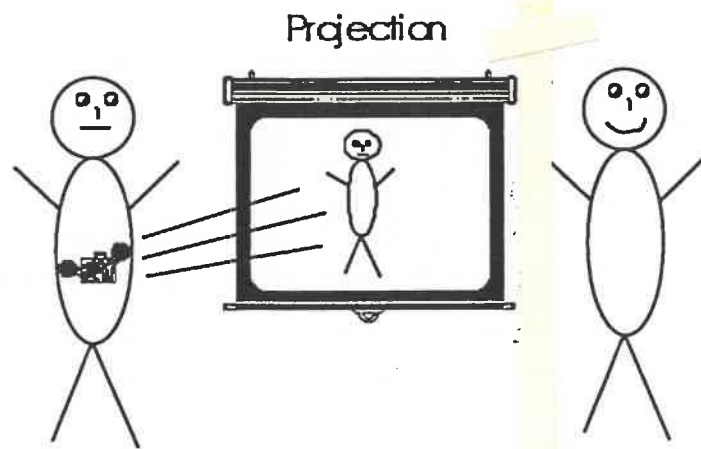
*Sometimes people think that something about them needs to be hidden because if people knew about it something bad would happen—either someone would get hurt or the other person would not love them. So they hide that piece of information—it becomes a **SECRET**. It torments them and **builds a wall** between them and whoever it is hidden from. That is the most terrible result of a secret. It separates you from people you love. But people feel trapped by their fear of being found out and what they believe are the consequences of not hiding whatever it is.*

Who has never been in that situation?

The way out of that trap is to be intimate. First with yourself and then with whoever else you need to talk to. To share your truth about you and to risk being vulnerable. If you are truly intimate the person you are being intimate with has space to experience whatever they are feeling as well. The result is almost always greater connection and closeness.

Share something intimate now with the person next to you.

 **PROJECTION** (workbook pg. 19)



When we are children we all project. Everything we see is based on our perception. For example, a little child thinks that if they close their eyes, no one can see them. Children don't experience themselves as separate. They only project until 5 years old or so, when they begin feeling separate from their parents.

As an adult, projection results in giving your energy and power away by thinking that you are behaving a certain way because someone else wants you to. Even if they do want you to!

Or thinking that someone else is feeling what you are feeling. We usu-

ally do this because we don't want to see ourselves. It is the story we tell ourselves after we have judged our feelings.

Anything that has a value judgement is a projection.

Exercise:

This is a difficult concept. To discover how you project:

1) Tell the person next to you what behaviors you do that you would never do if it weren't for other people.

2) Tell them what would happen if you were just yourself.

(Give them 15-20 minutes)

Have them write in their workbooks pg. 20.

HOW TO HANDLE A PROJECTION (*workbook pg. 21*)

- 1) Say the projection to yourself.** Notice how you are interpreting your experience.
- 2) Look at the effect of the projection** on yourself and the other person or people. Are you separate? Are you making yourself or someone else good, bad, superior or inferior?
- 3) Find out what is true about the projection** - something that you don't want to deal with or acknowledge is true about yourself. Be willing to experience the reality of the projection as it relates to you.
- 4) See what power the projection gives you.** When you hold on to your point of view, it controls the limits of what is possible. The other person has no say in the relationship.
- 5) If you dare, let the other person in.** This means to trust that the other person has no negative motivation, no matter what the evidence is to the contrary. Be vulnerable. With vulnerability comes true power and clarity.

 **Exercise:** *Using the steps for handling projections, break into pairs and take turns handling each of your projections and supporting your partner. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATE. (10-15 mins.)*

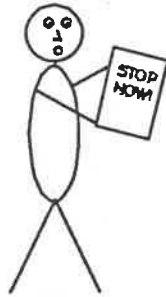
√Integrity

Inside = Outside (having one face). Being and living who you really are. It means that you live your life according to your true values. Doing this allows for rapid growth to occur with the least amount of stress.

√Self Respect

This is the result of being who you are and doing what you said you would do no matter what feelings get in your way. It is the result of living in integrity.

√True Guilt (*Refer to workbook: pg. 22*)



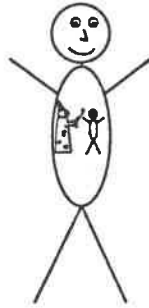
True guilt is a message from your soul to stop a particular behavior. It does not mean being afraid of punishment from someone else. It is a deep feeling inside that something you are doing, thinking or feeling is not not okay with you.

√Deepest Intentions = Results

When our results are not what we thought we wanted to have happen, it is because we had another, deeper intention that determined the result that we got.

✓**You are the source of your experience.** (*Refer to wkbk.pg. 23*)

This is the essence of Responsibility. If we are committed to living our life this way we are guaranteed freedom.



- ☞ During dinner and that evening, have them share what issues are left for them to deal with this weekend, and continue taking back all their projections, so that by the morning they are all responsible.
- ☞ Tell the group that you will all be taking a hike (or some similar physical activity) together for an hour in the morning. Let them know where and what time to meet.
- ☞ End with “In a Simple Way” or whatever is right for the feeling and work that people have been doing. (Hand out song words.)

DINNER

DAY THREE:

The walk is a place to connect very deeply with the participants. They are open and ready to talk about themselves and be seen. Use the walk as a place to find out the next level of information from the participants. Then, use the information in the morning sharing where appropriate and with their permission.

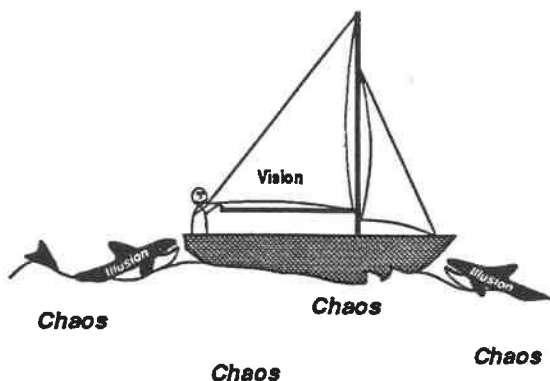
After the walk:

☞ Begin with “It’s About Time” and “In a Simple Way”

☞ Start the day with sharing. This will be their last chance to do a specific piece of work. Take it deep. Keep using the sharing and the information you teach to tie the whole weekend together.

☞ *Today we will be talking about how change works, how to create a vision, and how difficult change is. We will also begin to create the future.*

☞ **VISION** is your guide through the Sea of Chaos (wkbk. pg. 25)



When reactions threaten to take us over or when change feels too chaotic, having a vision of who we want to be and how we want to live pulls us through. It gives us something to steer by, something to remind us of our true selves in the midst of turmoil.

Vision:

Your vision is your guide through the chaos of change. It is your heart's picture of your soul's purpose. Remember what you found out about your purpose on Friday. A vision is literally a picture of who and what you have committed yourself to be. It pulls you through the roughest of times and past the siren call of illusion or comfort. It is a navigational guide that helps you choose the behavior that will get you your heart's desire.

Meditation: Play "Kitaro Ki"

Close your eyes and do some connected breathing. Just see a picture of infinity, an elongated figure 8. Relax your body, uncross your legs and float back in time. Just roll back in time.

Go back to a time when you realized that you were a real human, that you were there—a conscious being. Maybe you were 4 years old, maybe 5,6,7,8. If you haven't gotten in touch with that child yet, raise your hands. Create that child. Tell that part of yourself that is hiding, "be okay with that child." The rest of you be with that child. Let that child take you to a place where they felt the safest; where they felt themselves.

Now, that child knows that he or she is here to accomplish, to do, to be something. They are here because they have a job to do here, a mission. They chose this time to do a mission.

Let them tell you what they are here to do. It can be in words, a touch, a feeling. Let them tell you what they came here to accomplish.

Anyone not have anything told to them? Allow the child to show why you are here. Ask the question, "What is my purpose?"

How many got an answer you don't understand? If you do have an answer, enjoy and stay with your child. Those of you who didn't get an answer, ask that child if they trust you. Those of you that got a No, are you willing to really commit to listening to what the child has to say? For those of you that didn't get a purpose, stay with that child until you do.

Vision is your vehicle for creating a happy life and connecting with your soul's purpose.

Vision:

- *is a picture of you living your purpose in the moment*
- *demands action (it is not a result like "I will be wise or peaceful")*
- *is always about you*
- *needs to be bigger than you are now*

When you know the information is in solid, send everyone on a silent hour-long vision quest; to a spot that feels right; outside or inside.

This is your time to just be with yourself with no distractions. The purpose of the quest is to create a vision that you can truly commit to, no matter how small or large, and what new behaviors you will have to learn in order to live that new vision.

Play "I Want to Live" before they leave.

 ACTION

After the vision quest, meet briefly to talk about the importance of demonstrating their vision with their new behavior.

☞ Ask them to eat lunch with their groups and share their vision. The groups will support each other's vision for clarity and believability. Also, while in their groups, ask them to decide on an action they will do between the seminar and the reunion to demonstrate their vision.

LUNCH BREAK

☞ Teach the Model for Change as the tool they need to go through the work they will do if they commit to living their vision. Let them know that they can expect to hit resistance, be in illusion, experience chaos, etc. Tie the model into work that people have done throughout the weekend.

☞ Refer to the model diagram in the workbook to go over as you teach the information. (Refer to workbook page 26)

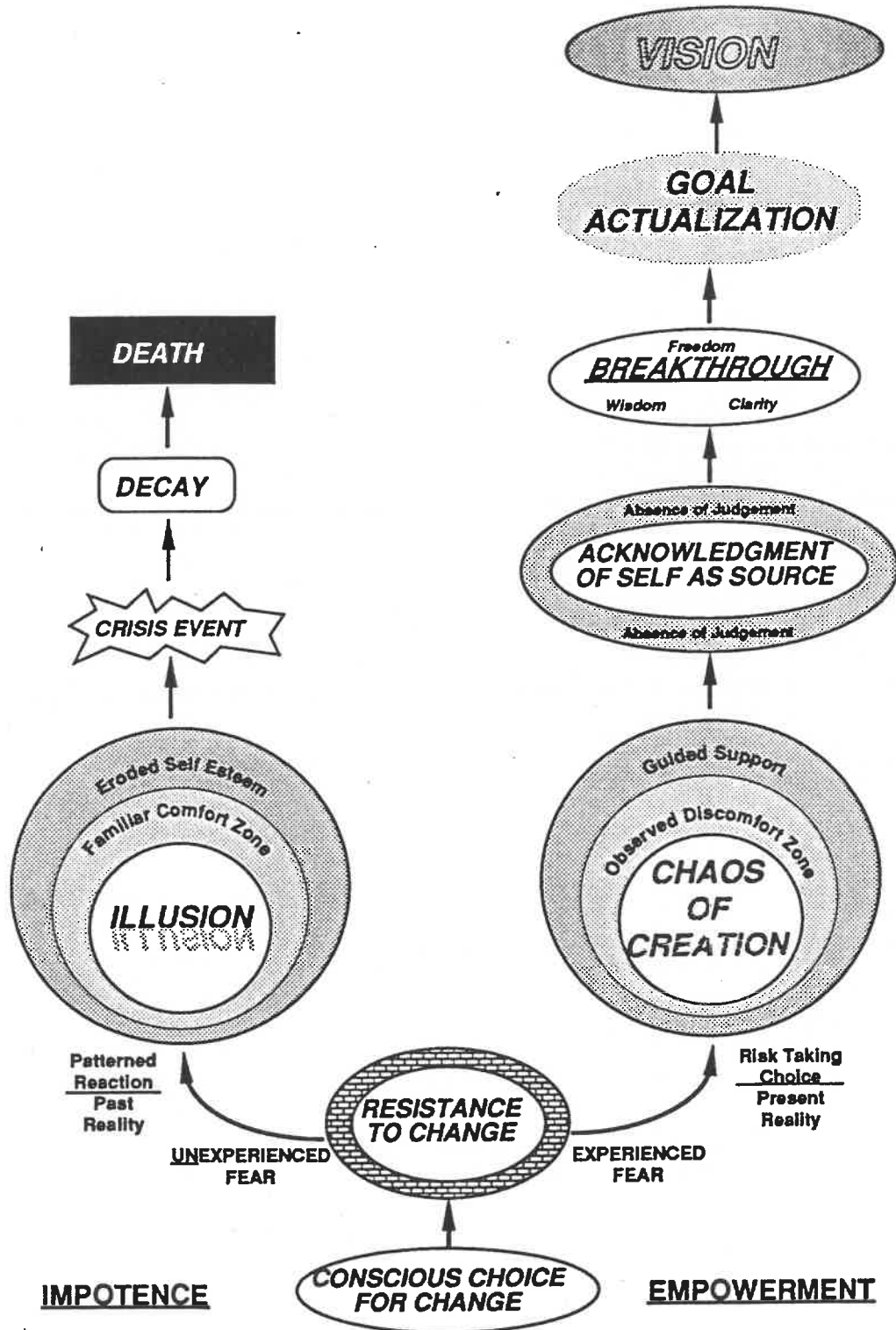
The Model for Change

Step 1) We decide to change something. The decision is best made with a clear vision of where we are going and a strong intention to get there.

Step 2) Immediately, our resistance hits. All the beliefs that created the original situation that we want to change go crazy! We want to change and yet we are afraid to do what it will take.

Step 3) If we don't experience the fear, we go into a reaction (our old pattern) and deceive ourselves about what is going on. We go into an illusion that creates a sense of comfort and familiarity. The problem is that our selves want us to be in integrity. Choosing illusion erodes our self-esteem.

MODEL FOR CHANGE



*Step 4) If we choose illusion often enough, our self arranges a **crisis** to get our own attention. Sometimes the crisis works. We remember that we wanted to change something. Sometimes we have to keep creating bigger and bigger crises. And sometimes we never can get through to ourselves and we die.*

*Step 5) On the other hand, if we do experience the fear and decide to risk a new way of being anyway, we go into the **chaos of creation**. We feel all the feelings that the old pattern protected us from. And if we can stay there and not bolt over to illusion we can create new possibilities that were out of the question under our old system of beliefs. We are literally choosing our reality from the raw material of our experience in the moment. Most of us need the support of our friends here to remind us of our vision - why we wanted to go through this in the first place.*

*Step 6) The next step is the most powerful and is the key to success. It is to **see ourselves as the source** of our experience and results and to let go of judgement. We take back into us all the power we ever tried to give to other people or to circumstance and concentrate it in ourselves. This is the essence of personal power.*

*Step 7) A curious thing happens at this point. We get so close to having what we want and all of a sudden things don't look like what we expected. Or maybe we don't think we are entitled to have what we want. We need to **breakthrough** our mind's last barrier!*

Step 8) We do all of steps 1,2, 5, 6 & 7 again and again as we go deeper and deeper into ourselves in living our vision.

When the model is complete go over it again and ask people: *Who has experienced themselves in resistance at all this weekend? In illusion? Anyone in crisis? Who has experienced chaos? Who is still in it? Who has experienced themselves as the source of their results? Who feels like they have had a breakthrough? And who has gotten what they came for already? Who is clear about their vision and what change they have to make in their behavior to live it? Who is committed to living that vision? Who is not?*

BREAK

After the break:

If there is time and the group is small, have people share their visions in the large group. Otherwise, have them share in their small groups, using the model for change, where they are on the model in terms of living their vision.

After the sharing, take the last break. (by 4:00)

BREAK Have participants do the feedback forms during break.

After the break: Do a review of the information and posters.

We have a bonus gift: Teach the Recipe for Ecstatic Sex.

- **Only make love when you both truly want to.**
- **Share everything while you're making love.**

Let your partner know what is going on in you.

- **Be responsible for your own sexuality.**

Make sure you have pleasure in the sexual experience.

Touch because it feels good to you.

- **Laugh and have fun.**

Sex is not such a serious thing.

☞ Teach them how to take the information from this seminar into their relationships and work situations. It is important not to talk much about this information but rather to **demonstrate** it. This gives people the space to notice the difference and ask questions.

☞ Let them know that there are **previews** (or whatever you have planned) coming up that they can bring friends and co-workers to, in order to enlarge their network of people in their lives that share this information and will support each other living it.

☞ Talk about the reunion. Where and when it is. Encourage them to bring anyone with them that they would like to **share the Weekend** with. Have them use their workbooks to set action steps for what they will do between now and the reunion (page 28). Also remind them of the reaction journal on page 29 for recording when they notice they are in reaction and what they choose to do.

☞ Let them know that there are other programs that they can do to continue learning this information if they so desire. Talk about the ETP and any other QED program coming up.

☞ Hand out information packets and review contents.

☞ **End Day Three:** Play “What a Wonderful World” and “The Rose”

HOW TO USE THE MUSIC - WHAT EACH PIECE EVOKES:

- 1) All this Joy—sets tone of unconditional love and acceptance
- 2) Almost Paradise—mushy love song, use for relationships
- 3) Always on my Mind—use for women about their fathers
- 4) Autumn Leaves—use for someone who is mourning a mate
- 5) Bridge over Troubled Waters—for fathers and daughters
- 6) Daddy's Little Girl—for women who are still in love w/daddy
- 7) Desperado—for men (or women) who don't let love in
- 8) Father and Son—for men angry at and yearning for dad
- 9) I Want to Live—for someone in despair
- 10) Imagine—sets tone for seminar
- 11) In a Simple Way—for someone who has demonstrated great courage
- 12) It's About Time—opens up a very big picture
- 13) Kitaro Ki—play during guided meditation
- 14) Lean on Me—bonds everyone
- 15) Let It Be—for letting go
- 16) Lovin' Arms—for anyone grieving a parent/relationship
- 17) Lullabye—for children and mothers
- 18) My Way—to acknowledge extreme stubbornness
- 19) Sweet Surrender—great hokey, down-home, big picture
- 20) The Living Years—great song for anyone who lost a father or is cut off from someone
- 21) The Rose—theme song
- 22) You are So Beautiful—to women from dad or to anyone who has really risked themselves
- 23) You Mean More to Me—a love song for couples
- 24) What a Wonderful World—good opener or closer any day
- 25) From A Distance—to promote peace and a sense of community
- 26) Changes Comin' On—for anyone who is afraid of change
- 27) I Am a Rock—anyone who is very independent or not feeling
- 28) Life is Eternal